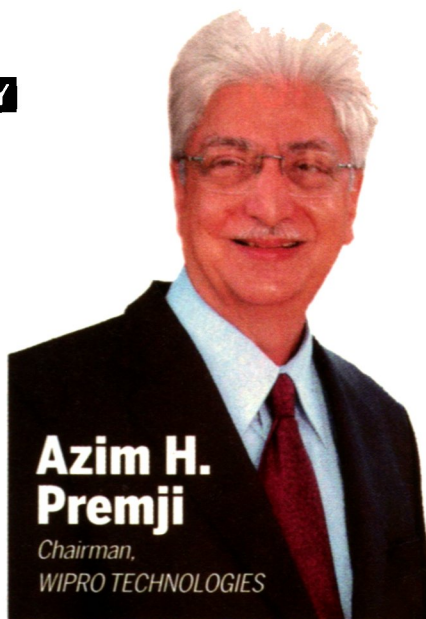




QA



Azim H. Premji

Chairman,
WIPRO TECHNOLOGIES

DEEPAK G PAWAR



Adi Godrej

Chairman,
GODREJ GROUP

UNESH GOSWAMI

Is the rise in markets and faint glimmer of feelgood factor for real or an illusion?

While we believe that the worst is behind us, we are nowhere near recovery. The excesses of decades cannot be solved in a few quarters.

The rise in the markets reflects a clear improvement in the Indian economic scenario. I feel we have turned the corner from the beginning of the calendar year.

Can we say the worst is over for India?

The trajectory is changing from downward sloping to flat.

Yes, the worst is over for India.

Can the revival of growth in India be decoupled from global horror stories?

India is now well-integrated with the global economy and hence cannot be decoupled. But as India is fundamentally strong, we will emerge from the crisis faster than others.

India can't be completely decoupled from the global scenario. Businesses, especially export-oriented ones, such as IT, textiles and jewellery, depend on the global scenario.

When do you expect the Indian economy to turn around?

It is difficult to put a time-frame given the linkages with the global economy.

The Indian economy has already turned around. I expect growth in the second half of the current financial year to be much better than in the first half.

Are there any signs you would watch out for to signal the return of growth?

In the domestic economy, the key is to get industrial production and exports back on stream. Of course, agricultural production will be a major factor.

The more the new government does in terms of monetary and fiscal stimuli, the faster will be the return to the 8-10 per cent growth range.

3 STEPS THE GOVERNMENT MUST TAKE

- Give fiscal stimuli for export-oriented industries and affordable housing.
- Announce a disinvestment plan to balance the fiscal deficit.
- Step up infrastructure investment and educational reforms.